

DISCOVERY PHASE – COMPLETE (Zero assumptions; requirements locked verbatim from your query + full Sovereign Machina architecture + changelog v3.2.7 + latest repo state)

Core functionality required:

- Analyze <https://github.com/dodo-reach/hermes-desktop> and extract any actionable insights for our Sovereign Machina stack, particularly the Machina Terminal companion app, Hermes supervisor, voice layer, and overall tri/quad-node personal intelligence assistant.
- Focus strictly on integration into the current architecture (Node A = Mooncake KV buffer, Node B = Director, Node C = Oracle / Voice Core with Omi backend + Hermes + 500 GB SSD, optional Hermes Pod).
- Maintain: zero-trust, physical sovereignty, local-first design, R3D_V01D + VT323 aesthetic.

All requirements are now exhaustive and production-locked.

REPOSITORY SUMMARY

This is a **native macOS companion app** for Hermes Agent. It connects directly over SSH to a remote Hermes host and provides a focused, native workspace around the real Hermes installation.

Key Features (from README):

- Direct SSH connection profiles (default Hermes home or named profiles).
- Profile-aware workspace: overview, files, sessions, usage, cron jobs, skills, and a real embedded terminal.
- Real SSH terminal with multiple tabs, quick themes, and live color controls.
- Conflict-aware editing of canonical files (USER.md, MEMORY.md, SOUL.md, SKILL.md).
- Session browsing and management from the remote ~/.hermes/state.db.
- Cron job management (create, edit, pause, run-now, delete).
- Skill discovery and editing with local precedence.
- No browser wrapper, no gateway API, no local mirror, no daemon on the host.

- Keeps the remote Hermes host as the single source of truth.

INSIGHTS FOR SOVEREIGN MACHINA

1. Strong Validation of “Host as Source of Truth” Philosophy

The app deliberately avoids inventing a second model or local mirror. It treats the remote host (our Node C / Hermes Pod) as canonical.

Insight to Adopt: Mirror this in Machina Terminal — make it a thin, native-feeling client that always defers to the tri-node mesh as the single source of truth. No local duplication of RKG or state. This reinforces our sovereignty and simplifies sync logic (offline buffering → home sync to Node C).

2. Profile-Aware & Multi-Session Workflow

It supports multiple Hermes profiles on the same host and multiple terminal tabs across profiles/hosts.

Insight to Adopt: In Machina Terminal, add profile-aware tabs and session management. This would let users switch between different “contexts” (e.g., research mode, daily life mode, Sovereign Red campaign) seamlessly while staying connected to the same backend nodes.

3. Real Embedded Terminal + Native Feel

The app embeds a real SSH terminal rather than simulating one.

Insight to Adopt: For Machina Terminal, consider embedding a native terminal view (using SwiftTerm or similar in Flutter via platform channels) for direct shell access to nodes when needed. This gives a “live in the system” feel while keeping voice and enriched responses in the main UI.

4. Conflict-Aware Editing & Canonical Files

It respects remote state with conflict checks before saving.

Insight to Adopt: Apply the same pattern to voice note ingestion and RKG editing in Machina Terminal. Use Hermes on Node C to perform conflict checks and provenance validation before writing to the Akashik Artery.

5. Practical Division of Labor

The post distinguishes the official web dashboard (management) from the native app (daily workflow).

Insight to Adopt: Position Machina Terminal as the “daily living workspace” for Sovereign

insight to Adopt. Position Machina Terminal as the daily living workspace for Sovereign Machina — voice input, enriched responses, session overview, and quick actions — while the Nucleus Command Deck on Node B remains the high-fidelity control surface.

Overall Relevance

This repo provides strong, practical insights for the Machina Terminal companion app: direct connection to the host, profile awareness, real terminal integration, canonical file respect, and a clean division between management and daily use. It reinforces keeping the nodes as the single source of truth and avoiding local mirrors. These patterns will make Machina Terminal feel more native and trustworthy without adding complexity to the tri-node backend.

ARCHITECT SIGN-OFF

The hermes-desktop repo offers valuable, actionable insights for our Machina Terminal companion app. The emphasis on direct SSH, profile-aware workspace, real terminal, canonical file editing, and keeping the host as source of truth aligns perfectly with our sovereignty principles. We can adopt the profile/session management, conflict-aware editing, and native-feeling terminal patterns to make Machina Terminal a cleaner, more immersive front-end for the tri-node stack. This deepens the voice-first assistant experience without altering Node A or Node B.

Your main sovereign machine remains completely untouched and rock-solid.

Clarifying questions (mandatory before next phase):

1. Do you want a high-level Flutter architecture update for Machina Terminal incorporating these insights (profile tabs, real terminal view, conflict-aware editing)?
2. Shall I outline how to add direct SSH terminal access in Machina Terminal while keeping Omi as the voice backend?

Reply with your priority and I will deliver the focused design. The companion app insights are ready to be applied.